

Make 2: AI Selfie

DH 101 – Week 3

Student Name: Natan Silva

Project: AI Selfie

Tools Used: ChatGPT / DALL·E (image generation)

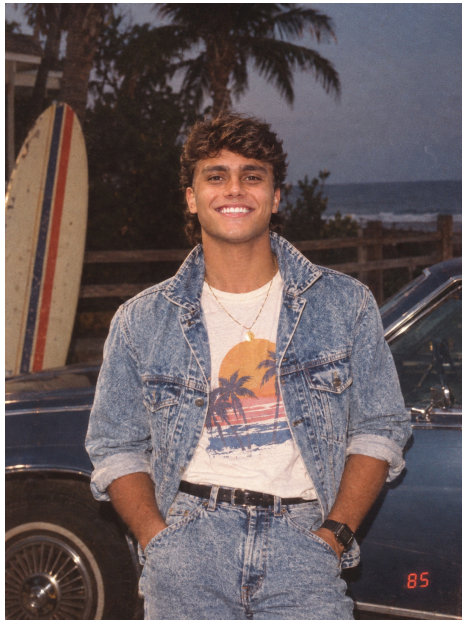
The Images (description)

Image 1: AI-Generated Stylized Selfie (Denison Campus / Anime Style)



The first image is a vibrant, anime-style digital illustration of me smiling in front of a campus setting. I am wearing a grey t-shirt that says "Denison Swimming & Diving." The background includes a statue of Mary with baby Jesus, a church tower, green trees, and a bright blue sky. The aesthetic is heroic, clean, and idealized, turning real-world details into an animated archetype.

Image 2: AI-Generated Vintage Selfie (80s Aesthetic)



In the second image, the AI recreated my selfie in a retro, 1980s film photographic style. I have a mullet hairstyle, wear an acid-wash denim jacket over a graphic t-shirt, and stand near a classic car and surfboard by the beach. The image features vintage film grain, warm lighting, and an '85 timestamp in the corner, shifting my visual identity through historical nostalgia.

Reflection

At first, both AI images changed how I look by using different styles. The first one turns me into a brightly lit, heroic anime character on a campus. The second one puts me in the 1980s, using old-school film grain, vintage clothes, and nostalgic details to place me in a decade I never lived in.

Even though both images keep some of my basic features like my smile, they show that AI builds identity out of common patterns instead of real life experiences. The anime picture replaces my actual personality with classic cartoon ideas of perfection and charm. Meanwhile, the 80s photo builds a fake memory by using cultural symbols like acid-wash denim and beach gear.

Looking at both pictures helped me see that AI doesn't show the "real" me. Instead, algorithms just sort, style, and rewrite who we are using popular visuals. The AI gives us cool-looking pictures, but we have to remember that these tools twist and idealize how we actually see ourselves.

Attribution & AI-Use Statement

AI Tool Used: ChatGPT / DALL·E

Prompt (summary):

- Image 1: “Using the provided image, transform the subject into a popular anime art style. Employ bold lines with slight variation and minimal cel-shading featuring flat shadow shapes. Use rich, saturated colors and clean, graphic lighting. The style should feature exaggerated, cartoon-like character proportions, including elongated, varied anatomy, and simple yet highly expressive facial features capable of conveying a wide range of emotions. Transform the setting into a slightly distorted space with a playful perspective and simplified objects. The composition and tone should be energetic, lively, and humorous, set within a fully stylized, non-realistic world.”
-
- Image 2: “Using my uploaded photo, show me what I would have looked like around 1985. Preserve my identity, facial features, skin tone, age, and recognizable appearance. Reimagine my hair, clothing, accessories, and surroundings with bold, unmistakably mid-1980s styling, expressive silhouettes, statement accessories, layered details, distinctive colors, and textures. Make it feel like a genuine 1985 photograph with analog grain, faded color, direct flash, and subtle softness. Add a period-accurate 1980s red-orange date stamp in the lower corner. No modern objects or text.”

AI Output: Generated both visual representations of the selfie in contrasting styles.

My Contribution: Conceived the concepts for both image styles, selected and arranged the generated images, analyzed the differences in visual representation, and wrote the reflection.